

of a fair number of intervening nodes, nodes that could well be separated by centuries.

5. It follows that any claim that the **f³⁵** archetype was created after the beginning of the minuscule period is either uninformed or perverse.

Postscript

Family 35 readings are attested by early witnesses, but without pattern, and therefore without dependency. But there are many hundreds of such readings. So how did the **f³⁵** archetype come by all those early readings? Did its creator travel around and collect a few readings from Aleph, a few from B, a few from P^{45,66,75}, a few from W and D, etc.? Is not such a suggestion patently ridiculous? The only reasonable conclusion is that the **f³⁵ text** is ancient (also independent).

I claim to have demonstrated the superiority of Family 35 based on size (number of representatives), independence, age, geographical distribution, profile (empirically determined), care (see above) and range (all 27 books). I challenge any and all to do the same for any other line of transmission!

Incredibly Careful Transmission

This section focuses on the Thessalonian epistles, generally thought to have been the first of the apostle Paul’s canonical writings (at least in conservative circles). If so, his prestige and authority as an apostle would not yet have reached its full stature, and in consequence such early writings might not have been accorded as much respect as later ones. As I continue collating more and more **f³⁵** MSS I have been surprised by a different picture. I have collated the following thirty-four representatives of the family and invite attention to the results.

Performance of **f³⁵ MSS in the Thessalonian Epistles**

MS	1 Thess.	2 Thess.	Location	Date ¹	Exemplar
18	---	---	Constantinople ²	1364	---
35	2c	---	Aegean ³	XI	---
201	2y,2/	2x	London	1357	2x,2y,2/
204	1	---	Bologna	XIII	1/
328	1/,1s	2s	Leiden	XIII	1/

¹ I give the location and date as in the *Kurzgefasste Liste* (1994), although I must admit to an occasional doubt as to the accuracy of the dating.

² Although presently in Paris, 18 was produced in Constantinople.

³ Although presently in Paris, 35 was acquired in the Aegean area.